

Monday, 20 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

23° 14°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

24° 13°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

24° 14°

GLASGOW

Partly cloudy

24° 15°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 The incoming Prime Minister Andy Burnham is reportedly scrapping plans for a national Digital ID system.

A spokesperson for Mr Burnham's team says the new government will focus on issues that matter most to people right now. This is expected to be one of his first major policy pledges.

POLITICS · UK

2 Controversial influencers Andrew and Tristan Tate have been arrested in the US, facing further charges from the UK.

The Crown Prosecution Service has requested their extradition, with a total of 59 charges now filed against them. The brothers' lawyer maintains their innocence.

CRIME · UK

3 Brace yourselves for longer waits at passport control if you're heading to Europe this summer, with a new EU border system tripling times.

An airport boss has warned of significant delays, and Ryanair is also advising passengers to prepare for extended queues. It's all due to the new automated entry/exit system.

TRAVEL · UK

4 A Chinese firm is seeking compensation from the UK government after British Steel was nationalised.

Jingye Group, which previously owned British Steel, says it will pursue legal action "to the very end". This follows the UK government's decision to take control of the steelmaker.

BUSINESS · UK

5 Incoming Prime Minister Andy Burnham is expected to announce fresh support for the North Sea oil and gas industry from day one.

There's speculation about whether this signals a new dawn for the sector under his leadership. It's a key area many will be watching closely as he takes office.

ENERGY · UK

What's coming up

1

Bruno Mars has made a triumphant return to UK stages after an eight-year absence, kicking off with a polished show at Wembley Stadium.

Fans flocked to see the superstar deliver a hit-filled performance. It sounds like he hasn't lost any of his magic, setting the stage for a fantastic series of gigs.

ON AIR – Have you seen Bruno Mars live? What's your favourite Bruno Mars track?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

2

Singer Gracie Abrams has just released her third album, capturing the pain of early adulthood with incisive and witty lyrics.

While critics are praising her songwriting, some feel the production could be stronger. It's definitely one for those who appreciate raw, honest storytelling in music.

ON AIR – What's your go-to album for navigating the ups and downs of early adulthood?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

3

Despite strict restrictions, K-pop has reportedly cut through in North Korea, with defectors revealing its surprising popularity.

It seems even in the most stifling of dictatorships, the infectious energy of K-pop finds a way. It's a fascinating insight into how cultural trends can transcend borders.

ON AIR – What's the most unexpected place you've heard your favourite music playing?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

4

Bulgarian singer Dara, who won Eurovision with 'Bangaranga', has revealed she nearly quit the competition twice before her historic victory.

It just goes to show that perseverance truly pays off! Her win in Vienna almost didn't happen, making her story even more inspiring.

ON AIR – Have you ever stuck with something and then had a huge breakthrough?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

5

A new documentary highlights the incredible impact Wham! had on people during their groundbreaking visit to China.

George Michael and Andrew Ridgeley's concerts reportedly changed lives, offering a rare glimpse of Western culture. It's a testament to the power of music to connect and inspire.

ON AIR – Which band do you think had the biggest cultural impact worldwide?

FILM · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

1 **England secured their best men's World Cup finish since 1966, beating France 6-4 in a thrilling third-place play-off.**

Bukayo Saka was the hero, scoring a hat-trick in a sensational ten-goal match. It's a fantastic achievement for the team, giving fans plenty to celebrate.

ON AIR – What's your favourite memory from England's World Cup run this year?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Ben Duckett has rewritten the record books, scoring a magnificent 141 in England's One Day International against India at Lord's.**

His incredible innings is now the highest score by any men's batter in an ODI at the historic venue. It beat Sir Viv Richards' long-standing record, making it a truly special moment.

ON AIR – What's the most impressive sporting record you've ever witnessed?

CRICKET · UK

3 **Mercedes' Kimi Antonelli has extended his championship lead with victory in the Belgian Grand Prix, while teammate George Russell crashed out.**

It was a dramatic race, with Antonelli re-establishing a comfortable gap at the top. A tough day for Russell, but a brilliant one for his teammate.

ON AIR – Do you think Antonelli can hold on to win the F1 championship this season?

FORMULA 1 · UK

4 **Great Britain's Bethany Shriever has claimed a historic fourth elite world title at the UCI BMX Racing World Championships.**

Persistent strong winds forced racing to be halted, with results taken from the last completed round. Shriever is now the first BMX racer to achieve this incredible feat, cementing her legend.

ON AIR – What's the most challenging sport you've ever tried, especially in bad weather?

BMX · UK

5 **Chelsea have reportedly agreed a club-record £117 million deal to sign England international midfielder Morgan Rogers from Aston Villa.**

This would be a massive transfer in the Premier League, signalling Chelsea's intent for the upcoming season. It'll be interesting to see how this impacts both teams.

ON AIR – Do you think £117 million is a fair price for Morgan Rogers, or is it too much?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A delightful new trend sees people creating 'miniature libraries' in their gardens for neighbours to share books.**
These tiny, weather-proof boxes are popping up in front gardens, offering a lovely way for communities to swap novels and magazines, fostering a real sense of local connection.
- 2 More households are rediscovering the charm of 'board game evenings' as a way to unplug and reconnect.**
Sales of classic board games are seeing a resurgence, with families opting for a screen-free evening of competitive fun and laughter around the dining table.
- 3 A quirky study suggests that 'the way you load your dishwasher' might reveal aspects of your personality.**
Are you a meticulously organised stacker or a free-spirited chuck-it-in-er? Researchers believe our dish-loading habits could offer a peek into our approach to daily tasks!
- 4 The simple act of 'doodling during meetings' is now being recognised as a surprising aid to concentration.**
Far from being a sign of distraction, experts say that light, unstructured drawing can help maintain focus and even improve memory retention during lengthy discussions.
- 5 A growing number of people are embracing the quiet satisfaction of 'mending clothes' instead of discarding them.**
From artful visible mending to discreet repairs, this trend promotes sustainability and cherishes garments, giving them a new lease of life with a personal touch.
- 6 The delightful practice of 'leaving small, cheerful notes' on public transport is bringing smiles to commuters.**
Imagine finding a tiny message wishing you a good day on your train seat! It's a lovely, anonymous way to spread a little bit of unexpected happiness.
- 7 Experts highlight a surprising benefit of 'walking backwards' occasionally: improved balance and spatial awareness.**
While not for everyday walks, incorporating short bursts of backward strolling in a safe environment can challenge your brain and muscles in new and beneficial ways.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to remember where we put our keys?

ANSWER: RETRACING OUR EXACT STEPS FROM WHEN WE LAST HAD THEM, OFTEN MUTTERING TO OURSELVES!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before using a new pen for the first time?

ANSWER: DOING A LITTLE 'TEST SCRIBBLE' ON A PIECE OF SCRAP PAPER TO CHECK IF IT WRITES SMOOTHLY!

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those 'unwritten rules' in our homes, don't we? The little understandings or habits that everyone just 'knows' but are never officially discussed.**

What are the unwritten rules in your household? Is it about who gets the last biscuit, or how the washing up is loaded, or perhaps a particular seat on the sofa?

- **Think about those 'everyday sounds' that you find surprisingly comforting or pleasing, the ones that just make you feel a bit warm and fuzzy inside.**

What are those comforting everyday sounds for you? Is it the gentle hum of the fridge, the distant chimes of a clock, or perhaps the bubbling of a kettle?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** There is a planet made almost entirely of diamonds, approximately twice the size of Earth, orbiting a nearby star.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts grow slightly taller in space due to the lack of gravity decompressing their spines, but shrink back to normal height upon returning to Earth.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's largest snowflake ever recorded was 15 inches wide and 8 inches thick, found in Montana in 1887.
- Cows don't have upper front teeth; instead, they have a thick, tough pad called a dental pad.
- The inventor of the Pringle can, Fredric Baur, requested to be buried in one, and his wish was granted.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- Hawaii is the only US state that grows coffee commercially.
- The 'sixth sick sheik's sixth sheep's sick' is considered the hardest tongue twister in the English language.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The Great Wall of China is not visible from space with the naked eye, despite popular myth.

On this day

Day 201 of the year, 164 days left in 2026. Today Birthday of Crown Prince Haakon Magnus (Norway); Christian feast day: Ansegisus; Christian feast day: Apollinaris of Ravenna; Christian feast day: Aurelius of Carthage. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1969 — Tobi Vail, American singer and guitarist
- 1973 — Omar Epps, American actor
- 1955 — Jem Finer, English banjo player and songwriter
- 1975 — Jason Raize, American singer and actor (died 2004)
- 1947 — Carlos Santana, Mexican-American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1944 — T. G. Sheppard, American country music singer-songwriter
- 1955 — Desmond Douglas, Jamaican-English table tennis player
- 1999 — Pop Smoke, American rapper and singer (died 2020)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1992 — Václav Havel resigns as president of Czechoslovakia.
- 1989 — Burma's ruling junta puts opposition leader Aung San Suu Kyi under house arrest.
- 2021 — American businessman Jeff Bezos flies to space aboard New Shepard NS-16 operated by his private spaceflight company Blue Origin.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2012 — James Holmes opened fire at a movie theater in Aurora, Colorado, killing 12 and injuring 70 others.
- 1999 — The Chinese Communist Party begins a persecution campaign against Falun Gong, arresting thousands nationwide.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1964 — Vietnam War: Viet Cong forces attack the capital of Định Tường Province, Cái Bè, killing 11 South Vietnamese military personnel and 40 civilians (30 of whom are children).
- 2019 — Soyuz MS-13 is launched to the International Space Station on the 50th anniversary of the Apollo 11 moon landing.

- 1992 — Václav Havel resigns as president of Czechoslovakia.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 202 of the year, 163 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alberic Crescitelli; Christian feast day: Albert John Luthuli (Episcopal Church); Christian feast day: Arbogast; Christian feast day: Barhadbesciabas. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1989 — Juno Temple, English actress
- 1988 — KB, American rapper
- 1998 — Maggie Lindemann, American singer-songwriter.
- 1970 — Michael Fitzpatrick, American singer-songwriter
- 1981 — Paloma Faith, English singer-songwriter and actress
- 1943 — Henry McCullough, Northern Irish guitarist, singer and songwriter (died 2016)
- 1948 — Cat Stevens, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1946 — Timothy Harris, American author, screenwriter and producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1960 — Sirimavo Bandaranaike is sworn in as prime minister of Ceylon, becoming the world's first democratically elected female head of government.
- 2005 — Four attempted bomb attacks by Islamist extremists disrupt part of London's public transport system.
- 2010 — U.S. President Barack Obama signs the Dodd–Frank Wall Street Reform and Consumer Protection Act.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1960 — Sirimavo Bandaranaike is sworn in as prime minister of Ceylon, becoming the world's first democratically elected female head of government.
- 1959 — NS Savannah, the first nuclear-powered cargo-passenger ship, is launched as a showcase for Dwight D. Eisenhower's "Atoms for Peace" initiative.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)